

Here is a structured **10-Day / 40-Hour Study Plan** tailored for the May 2025 version of the AI-900 exam.

This schedule prioritizes the high-weight **Generative AI** section and ensures you get hands-on familiarity with the new **Azure AI Foundry** terminology.

Schedule Overview

- **Daily Commitment:** 4 Hours
 - **Total Duration:** 10 Days
 - **Strategy:** Theory (Morning) → Hands-on/Video (Mid) → Practice Quiz (End)
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Phase 1: Foundations & Machine Learning (Days 1-3)

Day 1: AI Concepts & Responsible AI (15-20%)

- **Hour 1 (Read):** Introduction to AI Workloads (ML, Vision, NLP, GenAI, Document Intelligence).
- **Hour 2 (Deep Dive): Responsible AI.** Memorize the 6 principles (Fairness, Reliability, Privacy, Inclusiveness, Transparency, Accountability). Create a flashcard for each.
- **Hour 3 (Video/Lab):** Watch "Microsoft AI Fundamentals" intro videos on YouTube or Microsoft Learn. Explore the Azure Portal interface (create a free account if you haven't).
- **Hour 4 (Quiz):** Take a 20-question practice set specifically on Responsible AI scenarios (e.g., "A model denies a loan to a specific demographic—which principle is violated?").
- **Link:** [Introduction to AI concepts](#)

Day 2: Machine Learning Principles (15-20%)

- **Hour 1 (Read):** Differentiate the 3 core types: **Regression** (Numbers), **Classification** (Labels/Categories), and **Clustering** (Grouping).
- **Hour 2 (Deep Dive):** Understand the "black box" of training. Inputs = Features, Output = Labels. Understand Train vs. Validation datasets.
- **Hour 3 (Lab):** Go to Azure Machine Learning Studio. Click through the "Automated ML" wizard just to see the interface. You don't need to run a paid job, just see the options.
- **Hour 4 (Quiz):** Practice identifying the problem type. (e.g., "Predicting stock prices" → Regression).
- **Link:** [Introduction to machine learning concepts](#)

Day 3: Azure ML Tools (AutoML & Designer)

- **Hour 1 (Read):** Study **Automated ML (AutoML)**. Key concept: It automates algorithm selection and hyperparameter tuning. Best for "No Code" users.
- **Hour 2 (Read):** Study **Azure Machine Learning Designer**. Key concept: "Drag-and-drop" visual interface for building pipelines.
- **Hour 3 (Lab):** Use the "Designer" in Azure to drag a "Linear Regression" module onto the

canvas. Visualizing this helps memory.

- **Hour 4 (Review):** Review the difference between "Compute Targets" (where the training happens) and "Endpoints" (where the model lives for consumption).

Phase 2: Vision & Language (Days 4-6)

Day 4: Computer Vision (15-20%)

- **Hour 1 (Read): Azure AI Vision** capabilities: Image Classification vs. Object Detection.
- **Hour 2 (Deep Dive): OCR (Optical Character Recognition).** Understand the "Read API" for documents. Differentiate between "Vision" (general objects) and "Face" (emotion/identity).
- **Hour 3 (Lab):** Visit the [Azure AI Vision Studio](#). Use the demo to upload a photo of your desk and see what it detects.
- **Hour 4 (Quiz):** Practice questions focusing on which service to pick (e.g., "Scan a receipt" $\rightarrow$ Document Intelligence/OCR).
- **Link:** [Get started with computer vision](#)

Day 5: NLP - Text Analysis (15-20%)

- **Hour 1 (Read): Azure AI Language** service. Concepts: Sentiment Analysis, Key Phrase Extraction, Entity Recognition (NER).
- **Hour 2 (Deep Dive): Question Answering (QA)** and Conversational Language Understanding (CLU). Understand how bots interpret "intent" (what the user wants).
- **Hour 3 (Lab):** Visit [Language Studio](#). Try the "Analyze Sentiment" demo with different sentences.
- **Hour 4 (Quiz):** Focus on scenarios: "A hotel wants to analyze reviews" $\rightarrow$ Sentiment Analysis.
- **Link:** [Get started with NLP](#)

Day 6: NLP - Speech & Translation

- **Hour 1 (Read): Azure AI Speech.** Speech-to-Text (STT) and Text-to-Speech (TTS). Real-time vs. Batch transcription.
- **Hour 2 (Read): Azure AI Translator.** Text translation and Document translation (keeping formatting).
- **Hour 3 (Video):** Watch a demo of "Azure AI Speech Studio" creating a custom voice or transcribing audio.
- **Hour 4 (Review):** Consolidate all NLP services. Make a cheat sheet mapping "Service Name" to "Capability".

Phase 3: Generative AI & Exam Polish (Days 7-10)

Day 7: Generative AI Concepts (20-25%) - *Crucial Day*

- **Hour 1 (Read):** What are LLMs (Large Language Models)? How do they predict the next token?
- **Hour 2 (Deep Dive): Prompt Engineering.** Techniques: Zero-shot, Few-shot, Chain-of-thought. Understand "Grounding" (using your own data to stop hallucinations).
- **Hour 3 (Read): Copilots.** Understand the ecosystem: GitHub Copilot (Code), M365 Copilot (Docs/Email), Security Copilot.
- **Hour 4 (Quiz):** Focus on GenAI vocabulary: Token, Temperature, Prompt, Completion.
- **Link:** [Introduction to generative AI](#)

Day 8: Azure AI Foundry & Responsible GenAI

- **Hour 1 (Read): Azure AI Foundry.** This is the *new* big topic. Understand it is the "Unified Platform" for building AI apps.
- **Hour 2 (Deep Dive): Model Catalog.** Know that this is where you find GPT-4, Llama, Mistral, etc.
- **Hour 3 (Read): Azure AI Content Safety.** How to filter harmful inputs (jailbreaks) and outputs (hate speech).
- **Hour 4 (Quiz):** Scenarios involving safety: "How do we prevent the bot from swearing?"
\$to\$ Content Safety filters.

Day 9: Full Practice Mode

- **Hour 1:** Take the [Official Microsoft Practice Assessment](#). Do it in "Exam Mode" (timed).
- **Hour 2:** Review every wrong answer. Don't just read the right answer; find out *why* the other 3 were wrong.
- **Hour 3:** Target your weakest area. (Usually GenAI or specific Vision services). Re-read that module.
- **Hour 4:** Take the practice assessment again. Aim for 80%+.

Day 10: Final Polish

- **Hour 1:** Review your "Cheat Sheet" of service names. (Vision vs Face, Language vs Speech).
- **Hour 2:** Review the 6 Responsible AI principles again (they are easy points if you know them).
- **Hour 3:** "Azure AI Foundry" vocabulary check. Ensure you aren't using old terms like "Bot Framework Composer" (mostly deprecated/legacy).
- **Hour 4:** Relax, hydrate, and prepare your testing environment (if taking online) or bag (if going to a center).